

# Interviewer Effect Simulation Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Human Sciences • 30-40 min

|            |                |      |                               |
|------------|----------------|------|-------------------------------|
| Category   | Human Sciences | Time | 30-40 min                     |
| Difficulty | Medium         | ID   | interviewer-effect-simulation |

Big idea: In human sciences, the person asking can become part of the evidence produced.

## One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students conduct mini-interviews with different interviewer styles and compare how method shapes responses.

## Student Prompt

Inspect Interviewer Effect Simulation Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

## Concrete Stimulus Packet

|                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Interviewer Effect Simulation Stimulus A     | Student-facing stimulus 1: Question: 'How useful is homework for learning?' Styles: warm, rushed, leading, skeptical, neutral. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result. | Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.                                                      |
| Interviewer Effect Simulation Stimulus B     | Student-facing stimulus 2: Question: 'What makes a classroom discussion good?' Styles: encouraging, distracted, formal. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.        | Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.                                                                              |
| Interviewer Effect Simulation Reveal / Twist | Student-facing stimulus 3: Question: 'What makes a classroom discussion good?' Styles: encouraging, distracted, formal. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.        | Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — In human sciences, the person asking can become part of the evidence produced. |

## Actual Lesson Questions

| # | Question for students                                                                          | Teacher key / cue                                                                                             |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | After inspecting Interviewer Effect Simulation Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim? | Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.                                                  |
| 2 | Which exact detail from Interviewer Effect Simulation Stimulus A did you use as evidence?      | Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues. |
| 3 | What did you infer beyond the evidence?                                                        | Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.                       |
| 4 | How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?                                       | Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.                                                 |
| 5 | What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?                               | Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.                                    |
| 6 | How can data be shaped by the method used to collect it?                                       | Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.                          |

## Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Human Sciences.

## Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how in human sciences, the person asking can become part of the evidence produced.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

## Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How can data be shaped by the method used to collect it?

## Setup Checklist

- Use safe topics such as homework routines, cafeteria preferences, or study environments.
- Assign interviewer styles openly so students can analyze method rather than feel manipulated.

## Example Stimuli or Materials

- Question: 'How useful is homework for learning?' Styles: warm, rushed, leading, skeptical, neutral.
- Question: 'What makes a classroom discussion good?' Styles: encouraging, distracted, formal.

## Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/interviewer-effect-simulation/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/interviewer-effect-simulation/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/interviewer-effect-simulation/visual-prompt.svg>
- Interview style cards.
- Response comparison sheet: length, detail, hesitation, confidence, interviewer influence.

## Run Sequence

1. Pairs receive the same interview question but different interviewer style cards.
2. Students conduct short, low-stakes interviews.
3. Respondents reflect on how the style affected their answer.
4. Groups compare differences in length, confidence, and content.
5. Debrief interviewer effects and research reliability.

## Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How can data be shaped by the method used to collect it?
- Can a neutral interview ever be fully neutral?

- What does ethical interviewing require?

## **Teacher Quick Script**

- The question is not the only method; the social situation is part of the method.
- How did the interviewer change what felt safe or relevant to say?

## **Exit Ticket**

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...